

“Open source development at **Google** *is both very diverse and distributed*”

Everyone knows that Google is a leader in the open source world. But what is it that makes it a distinct player in the fast-growing developer community? **Will Norris**, the **engineering manager at Google's Open Source Programs Office**, reveals some secrets in an exclusive talk with **Jagmeet Singh** of **OSFY**. Edited excerpts...



Q What is the development model for open source technologies at Google?

Open source development at Google is both very diverse and distributed. The larger projects that we release generally have dedicated teams developing and supporting the project, working with their external developer communities and providing internal support to other Googlers. Many of the smaller projects include just one or two engineers working on something experimental or just a fun, side project. While we do have a central Open Source Programs Office (the group I manage), it is relatively small compared to the size of the company. Instead, the actual development happens throughout the company, with hundreds of teams and thousands of engineers, tech writers, designers and product managers contributing to open source in some way.

Will Norris, engineering manager at Google's Open Source Programs Office